



Figure 2: Android features

camera aperture, ISO levels, pixel size, auto-focus and more, are also important.

Battery – the energy lifeline: It is important to have a battery with staying power. If you are a heavy user and work on apps, play games, stream videos and more, then go for a smartphone with at least a 3500mAh battery or above. If you are an average or light user, a handset with a 3000mAh battery would be good enough to run for a full day.

The build – the benchmark for durability: The build is directly linked with the durability of a smartphone. The entire handset market is broadly divided into two types of builds - metal and plastic. Which option you select should be based on how you evaluate your own usage pattern – do you tend to be very careful with your devices or are you clumsy and rough?

User interface – it's all about interaction: The user interface and OS version are key factors to choosing the best devices. The interface is that part of the phone that you interact with each time you access any function, so it should be easy and simple.

Storage – when data is a prized commodity: Nowadays, storage is available in options of 16GB, 32GB, 64GB or more. Higher storage volumes are mainly required by users who store movies or play heavy games.

Security – the main concern: Our smartphone contains private data and pictures that we don't want to share with anyone. So, security features are important and can include fingerprint sensors or even iris sensors.

Service – the connectivity: Another factor to consider when selecting a

carrier and an Android phone is whether or not it supports the newer, high-speed 4G networks.

Design – the look and the feel: A very important feature is the look and feel of a device. If the device fits in your hand then it is easy to access its features.

Top ten smartphones and tablets

In this section we present, what in my opinion are the ten top smartphones and tablets currently.

1. Google Pixel XL

Google Pixel XL was launched in October 2016, and is made by Google itself. In India, the price of the phone starts from ₹ 38,198. It is available on Amazon, Flipkart or its official



Figure 3: Google Pixel XL

website. Google Pixel XL has a 1.6GHz quad-core Qualcomm Snapdragon 821 processor, which is one of the latest and is fast, and 4GB of RAM. Google Pixel XL runs the 7.1 version of Android, and has an excellent performance in all areas, including battery life. It has a single SIM slot. One drawback of this device is that its storage capacity cannot be expanded.

Please refer to the official website for further queries or to buy the smartphone: https://store.google.com/product/pixel_phone

2. OnePlus 5T

OnePlus 5T was launched in November 2017. In India, its price starts from ₹ 32,999. The OnePlus 5T is driven by a 2.45GHz octa-core Qualcomm Snapdragon 835 processor and 6GB of RAM (which is the same as your laptop). It provides the dual SIM (GSM and GSM) option, and takes a Nano

SIM in each slot. It offers users super connectivity options including Wi-Fi, GPS, Bluetooth, NFC, USB OTG, 3G, 4G, etc. However, one disadvantage of this smartphone is that the photo quality in daylight is not the best.

Please refer to the official website for further queries or to buy the smartphone: <https://oneplusstore.in/5t>

Figure 4: OnePlus 5T

3. Nokia 8

Nokia 8 was launched in August 2017.

In India, its price starts from ₹ 32,899. This phone has a 1.8GHz octa-core Qualcomm Snapdragon 835 processor and 4GB of RAM. It is a dual SIM device that takes a Nano SIM in each slot. Its connectivity options include

Figure 5: Nokia 8

Wi-Fi, GPS, Bluetooth, NFC, USB OTG, 3G and 4G. The two drawbacks of this smartphone are its poor camera performance in low light and that it is not fully waterproof.

Please refer to the official website for further queries or for buying the smartphone: https://www.nokia.com/en_in/phones/nokia-8

4. Sony Xperia XZ Premium

The Sony Xperia XZ Premium was launched in February 2017. It is designed by Sony Mobile (previously known as Sony Ericsson Mobile). In India, the price of the phone starts from